

- They have a good turnaround in getting bug fixes which, in turn, increases the frequency in which you can get updated versions.
- They are supported by the open source community, where community members can submit features and fixes, which then get added to these ROMs.

If you have not yet explored the complete feature box-set of Android, shown below are the 'Top 5' custom Android ROMs that you could try. There are more custom ROMs out there with some unique features, but most of them don't support a wide range of devices.

'Top 5' custom ROMs available in the Android community

CyanogenMod
Paranoid Android
PAC-ROM
SlimROM
OmniROM

CyanogenMod

CyanogenMod is one of the best custom ROMs available in the open source Android community. A very large community of developers contribute to it, and a large number of users have it on their phones and tablets. With frequent updates like Nightly and Stable builds, it's no wonder that this is considered one of the most reliable custom ROMs by current users. Currently, those at CyanogenMod are working hard to bring out the latest version of the Android operating system called Marshmallow 6.0 on their supported phones and tablets. CyanogenMod's OS will be named CM13.0.



Figure 1: Cyanogen Mod logo

Based on the Android Open Source Project, CyanogenMod is designed to offer better performance and reliability than the Android based ROMs released by vendors and carriers such as Google, T-Mobile, HTC, etc. CyanogenMod also offers a variety of features and enhancements that are not currently found in stock versions of the Android OS (Source: <http://www.cyanogenmod.org/about>).

CyanogenMod supports most Android phones and tablets available in the market. To find out if your device is supported, follow <https://wiki.cyanogenmod.org/w/Devices>

If you don't find your device in the list of supported devices but you are keen on trying out CyanogenMod, then you can follow its porting guide on how to port its OS to your phone or tablet at <https://wiki.cyanogenmod.org/w/>

Doc: _porting_intro

Paranoid Android

Paranoid Android or AOSP+ has been one of the best ROMs in the Android community for a long time. It has a lot of features and also a large user base of more than 200,000 (Source: Wikipedia).

Some of its features include:

- Hover
- Immersive mode
- Pie
- Peek

It also supports dynamic system bar and a theme engine, which is powered by Cyanogen Mod. If you are looking for a sleek custom ROM with more intuitive features, this would be the right choice.

<http://www.paranoidandroid.co/>

PAC-ROM



Figure 2: Pac-Rom logo

PAC-ROM includes the best features among all the above ROMs, and provides them in a single package. Since this is a mix of everything, this ROM ought to be everyone's choice — if they are looking out for all the crazy features, along with the stability.

<http://www.pac-rom.com/>

SlimROMs

SlimROMs, as the name suggests, is a completely stripped down version of Android. It has many features and offers up to three variants that can be deployed in your device, based on your needs. There are lots of other features, too, which are listed below:



Figure 3: SlimROMs logo

- 'The Real Dark Slim' is a theme which makes the UI black, in addition to several other features
- SlimROMs has completely different 'recent' and 'favourite' apps windows, and this includes the option to switch to either side. So it doesn't matter whether you are